science into policy; among other points.

Rio + 20 harped on the concept of inclusion of stakeholders at all levels, which will benefit in decisions which will be participatory rather being ad hoc. Partnership between government and stakeholders will ensure viability, equitability and sustainability of environment and life on the Earth. Rio + 20 was an exercise by countries attending the Conference to rethink and redefine the way in which all stakeholders can engage, participate and shape decisions at all levels of government processes.

A follow up of Rio + 20 is the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development. Its uniqueness is its universality. It means that it is applicable to all countries having different levels of development. It focuses on shared responsibilities and mutual accountability on the basis of global partnership. 2030 Agenda included 17 Sustainable Development goals (SDGs) and 169 targets. Heads of states and governments adopted the **Transforming Our World: The 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development** on 25 September, 2015 at the UN Summit on Sustainable Development. In 2019, there was an all out call for decade of action to work towards sustainable development and achieve goals by 2030.

The SDGs include eradication of poverty, hunger, ensuring good health, well being, education, clean water and sanitation, affordable and clean energy, decent work and economic growth, industry, reducing inequality, sustainable cities and communities, responsible consumption and production, climate action, life below water, life on land, peace, justice and strong institutions and partnership for the goals.

Gender and Development: GDI, GII and GEM

The **Millennium Development Goals (MDGs)** very much uphold gender equality and women's empowerment and identified goals for achieving the same. The Millennium Project Task Force on Gender Education has developed a framework outlining why gender equality is so important to each of the MDGs. The Framework in the line of the Task Force is provided in Table 14.1.